> was the first to settle in Chotanagpur when it established stations in Munda territory in 1845. It had 40,000 converts by 1895… . Santals and Hos rarely converted; the bulk of adivasi Christians were Mundas and Oraons.
>
> *Education given by the different missions, based on European values, contributed to the adivasis' deculturation, and its effects are clearly observable today.*
>
> *…. Jharkhand's socioeconomic evolution in the course of history, summarily described above, gives evidence that supports my contention that it is erroneous to place Jharkhand's adivasi societies within the artificially created framework of tribe.*
>
> *…. In sum, given the qualitative aspects of the social and economic organization of the adivasi precapitalist societies of Jharkhand in pre-colonial India as well as after their subsumption under colonial capitalism, their categorization as 'tribal' is at best, out of place and, at worst, ahistorical and sociologically groundless. There were in fact no tribes in Jharkhand. In essence they were a parthenogenetic creation of British colonial administration. Only by a curious trick of historical reversion could there be tribes nowadays. Adivasis live in a class society, and exist in an economic formation where the capitalist mode is dominant. What does exist, however, is the ideology of tribe which, in Wolpe's words, 'sustains and reproduces capitalist relations of production' (1972: 454)* [emphases added].

It is evident from the above excerpts that both Dirks and Devalle end up showcasing the undeniable hand of coloniality in the creation of 'caste' and 'tribe' *as we know and understand it today*. This qualification 'as we know and understand it today' is of vital importance because it underscores the impact of coloniality on aspects of indigenous society, which popular discourse treats as being representative of its unchanging character and nature. I must clarify that it is not my case that the precolonial past was perfect or that there were no instances of discrimination; instead, I am merely making the point, citing credible literature, that our understanding of the past is thoroughly colonialised, and only when the colonial strings are removed from the discourse, can we truly begin to understand *varna* and *jati* from the standpoint of their history as well as examining them for contemporary relevance, if any.